

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Payment & Eligibility Terms

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

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Overview

This document outlines the payment methods, eligibility requirements, and billing policies for Aether Wireless customers. It covers accepted payment types, installment plan qualifications, credit check procedures, prepaid deposit terms, dispute resolution timelines, and automated payment reminders. All staff should reference these terms when assisting customers with billing inquiries, payment arrangements, or account eligibility questions.

Payment Methods

Accepted Payment Methods

Payment Method	Settlement Time	Notes
Credit/Debit Card	Instant	Visa, Mastercard, American Express, Discover
ACH Bank Transfer	3–5 business days	Electronic check from checking/savings account
In-Store Cash/Card	Instant	Available at Aether Wireless retail locations
Digital Wallet	Instant	Apple Pay, Google Pay, Samsung Pay
Mailed Check	7–10 business days	Must include account number and payment stub

Payment Method Requirements

- Account Holder Verification:** The funding account (bank account or card) must belong to the account holder on record. Third-party funding is not permitted except for authorized account managers listed on business accounts.
- Prepaid Cards:** Prepaid credit or debit cards may be used for one-time payments only. They cannot be saved for recurring autopay transactions.
- Prepaid Accounts:** Autopay enrollment is not available for prepaid service accounts. Prepaid customers must make manual payments each billing cycle.

Payment Plan Installments

Eligibility Criteria

Customers may qualify for a payment plan installment option under the following conditions:

1. **Account Status:** The account must be active and in good standing (no suspended service).
2. **Tenure:** The account must have been active for at least 12 consecutive months.
3. **Minimum Balance:** The outstanding balance must be at least \$100 to qualify.
4. **Plan Limit:** A maximum of 3 monthly installments per plan is allowed.
5. **Frequency:** Payment plans may be used once every 6 months.
6. **Default History:** The account must have no payment plan defaults within the last 12 months.
7. **Approval Threshold:** Payment plans totaling \$500 or more require manager approval before activation.

Interest Terms

- The first approved payment plan carries 0% interest.
- Subsequent payment plans (within any 6-month period) accrue interest at 5% APR.

Credit Check Requirements

Scenario	Credit Check Type	Purpose
Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)	Soft Pull	Verifies identity and eligibility; does not affect credit score
Device Financing/Installment	Hard Pull	Required for financed device agreements; may impact credit score
Prepaid Service	None	No credit check is performed

Prepaid Deposits

- **Deposit Amount:** Customers may be required to pay a refundable deposit ranging from \$100 to \$500, determined by credit evaluation or payment history.
- **Refund Eligibility:** The deposit is refunded to the customer's account after 12 consecutive months of on-time payments, provided the account remains in good standing.
- **Application:** The deposit is applied first to any outstanding balance. Any remaining balance is credited to the account or issued as a refund check.

Dispute Resolution

Billing Dispute Policy

- **Dispute Window:** Customers must initiate a billing dispute within 60 days of the charge date.
- **Investigation Period:** Aether Wireless will complete the investigation and provide a resolution within 5 business days of receiving the dispute.

- **Escalation:** If the customer is not satisfied with the resolution, they may escalate the matter to the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB). Aether Wireless will provide the CFPB contact information and cooperate with any formal review.

Autopay and Payment Reminders

Autopay Enrollment

- Customers with postpaid accounts may enroll in autopay via the customer portal, mobile app, or by contacting customer care.
- Autopay deductions occur on the due date or the business day prior if the due date falls on a weekend or holiday.
- Autopay is not available for prepaid accounts.

Reminder Schedule

Timing	Notification Type
3 days before due date	Payment reminder (email/SMS)
Day 7 past due	First past-due notice
Day 15 past due	Second past-due notice
Day 30 past due	Final warning notice; service suspension may be triggered
Day 45 past due	Account suspension; late fee applies

FAQs

Q: Can I use a prepaid debit card for autopay?

A: No. Prepaid cards cannot be used for recurring autopay. They are accepted only for one-time manual payments.

Q: How soon can I get a refund on my prepaid deposit?

A: After maintaining 12 consecutive months of on-time payments, the deposit is refunded to your account or issued as a check, minus any outstanding balances.

Q: Will a credit check be run if I bring my own phone?

A: No. For BYOD, a soft pull is performed to verify identity, which does not affect your credit score.

Q: What happens if I miss a payment plan installment?

A: Missing a payment plan installment may result in a default, which disqualifies you from future payment plans for 12 months. The remaining balance may be subject to late fees and service suspension.

Q: Can I set up a payment plan if my balance is under \$100?

A: No. The minimum balance required to qualify for a payment plan is \$100.

Q: How do I escalate a billing dispute if I'm not satisfied?

A: After the 5-day investigation, you may escalate the dispute to the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB). Aether Wireless will provide the escalation process and contact information.